In addition to India, the Indo-Pacific includes a number of major and emerging powers. The United States has a substantial interest in the region, and it includes, of course, China. Under its current leadership, Russia has shown tremendous resilience and boldness in pursuing its foreign and security policy objectives, including in the Middle East. Even if the United States views Russia as a security competitor, for India and the Indian people, Russia is a provider of defence and energy security. However, the official Russian worldview has not shifted from the traditional conception of the Asia-Pacific, and economic and geopolitical circumstances have forced Russia to look eastward towards China. The intention behind Russia's relationships in Asia is now to balance its overdependence on China. Therefore, although Russia is also likely to play some role in the Indo-Pacific, its role is likely to remain limited. An emerging power, Japan, on the other hand, is very much part of the Indo-Pacific, as are South Africa, Saudi Arabia, Iran, and Australia. The continental and maritime member countries of ASEAN are at the heart of the region.

India's interests in the Indo-Pacific

The foremost area of interest to India within the Indo-Pacific is the Indian Ocean and its littoral. The doctrine of the Indian Navy describes the Indian Ocean area as a "primary" area of interest.[20] As postulated by the Indian statesman and diplomat K. M. Panikkar, "though to other nations the Indian Ocean is important, to India this oceanic area is vital."[21] Unlike the Atlantic and Pacific Oceans, the Indian Ocean is "closed," in the sense that if the Suez Canal and Bab-el-Mandeb Strait in the west and the Malacca and Sunda Straits in the east were to be closed, entry into and exit from the Indian Ocean area would be difficult. The only ingress into it,